



THE UNITE INNOVATION & TRANSFORMATION MODELS

The UNITE Jobs to be Done Statement & Map

The Jobs to be Done Statement and Map allow you to outline the important but unmet needs that your customer wants to have solved. Jobs to be Done is the most critical tool to focus your innovation efforts, allowing you to systematically put the customer at the heart of your innovation process.

A part of the Digital Leadership Value Management Reference Content: #DL-MS-VM-JTBD-FRAME.
More information on this model is available here: <https://digitalleadership.com/UNITE/Jobs-to-be-Done>

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THE UNITE INNOVATION & TRANSFORMATION MODELS

The UNITE Jobs to be Done Statement & Map

If you find this model intriguing, learn more about how to use it to jump start innovation in your business in our book, How to CREATE INNOVATION.

The book is available here:

<http://digitalleadership.com/createinnovation>

A brief, formal definition of Jobs to be Done (JTBD)

The business challenge: The #1 problem when it comes to innovation is that we tend to analyze and understand the world entirely from the business's own perspective. We lack the framework and mental models to include the customer in our conversations and decision-making. This cannot work and we see it in the numbers: most innovation projects fail.

Jobs to be Done offers two key insights:

- > A mental model and a structured approach to understanding the needs of your customers (looking good instead of weight management, good entertainment instead of TV, leisure instead of a sailboat, etc.) and which criteria they use to measure the outcome.
- > A methodology to identify the *most important but underserved customer needs* in a quantifiable and verifiable way. Basically, it helps you understand what outcomes customers truly value, but are not yet able to achieve.

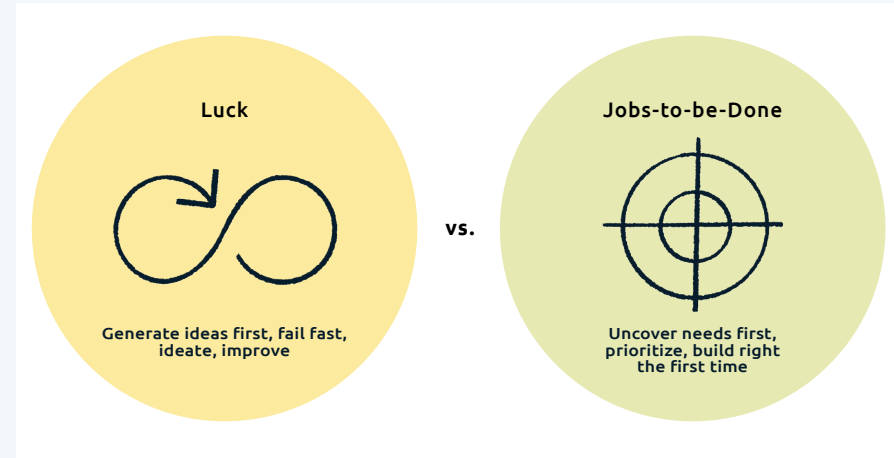
Thereby JTBD gives you a verifiable and precise understanding of where you can innovate to solve a big unmet need and your progress towards a successful outcome.

The business result: most innovations fail since they try to solve an unknown problem for an unknown customer. Through Jobs to be Done, you can eliminate bias and data noise, and instead precisely focus *on important but underserved customer needs*. Jobs to be Done thus replaces the uncertainty of guesswork and ideation.

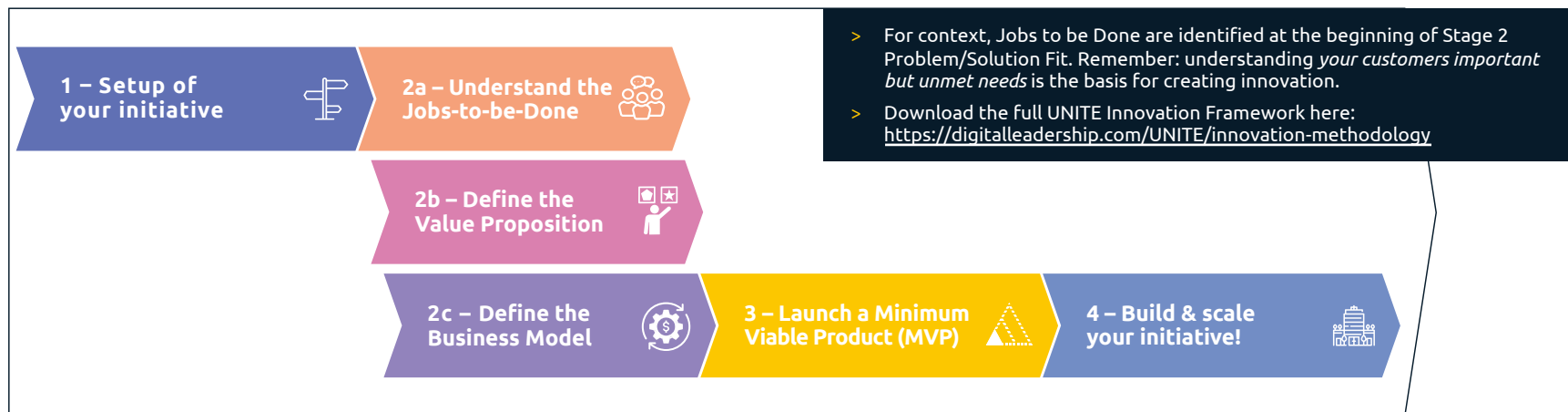
> **How to Create Innovation** provides an in-depth discussion on the topic of Jobs to be Done. The contents contained in these download packages are not fully sufficient to grasp the full theory if you have no prior knowledge on the topic.

The business argument for Jobs to be Done

- > In an independent study of different innovation methods, Strategyn, one of the companies which has developed and led the Jobs-to-be-Done approach, found that the success rate of their JTBD innovation approach was 86% compared to the average success rate of traditional innovation methods, which was 17%. The relative success of JTBD should not come as a surprise; a targeted innovation approach naturally outperforms most ideation/luck-based methods.
- > But the process requires rigor. There is no point in going through all the hoops if we only end up making unproven, potentially biased assumptions about the customer based on our own gut feelings. This is why we recommend setting aside the necessary investments to include the customers in your work in a qualitative *and* quantitative way.
- > Innovation badly needs increased investment security. As we've noted, the most optimistic statistics give corporate as well as private start-up innovations a failure rate of 70%, with the most negative statistics suggesting a 96% failure rate within the first four years. Of those remaining, only a fraction of them are successful; most innovations remain small and are irrelevant to the overall market. The biggest reason for these shocking numbers is that people are not taking the time to understand their customers' needs sufficiently.



THE UNITE INNOVATION APPROACH | OVERVIEW



Search field
Opportunity space

#JTBD

DESIGN
THINKING

Business
model
innovation

Steve Blank
Customer
development

THE LEAN
STARTUP

Conversion
optimization

Scrum

Growth
Hacking

MANAGEMENT Y



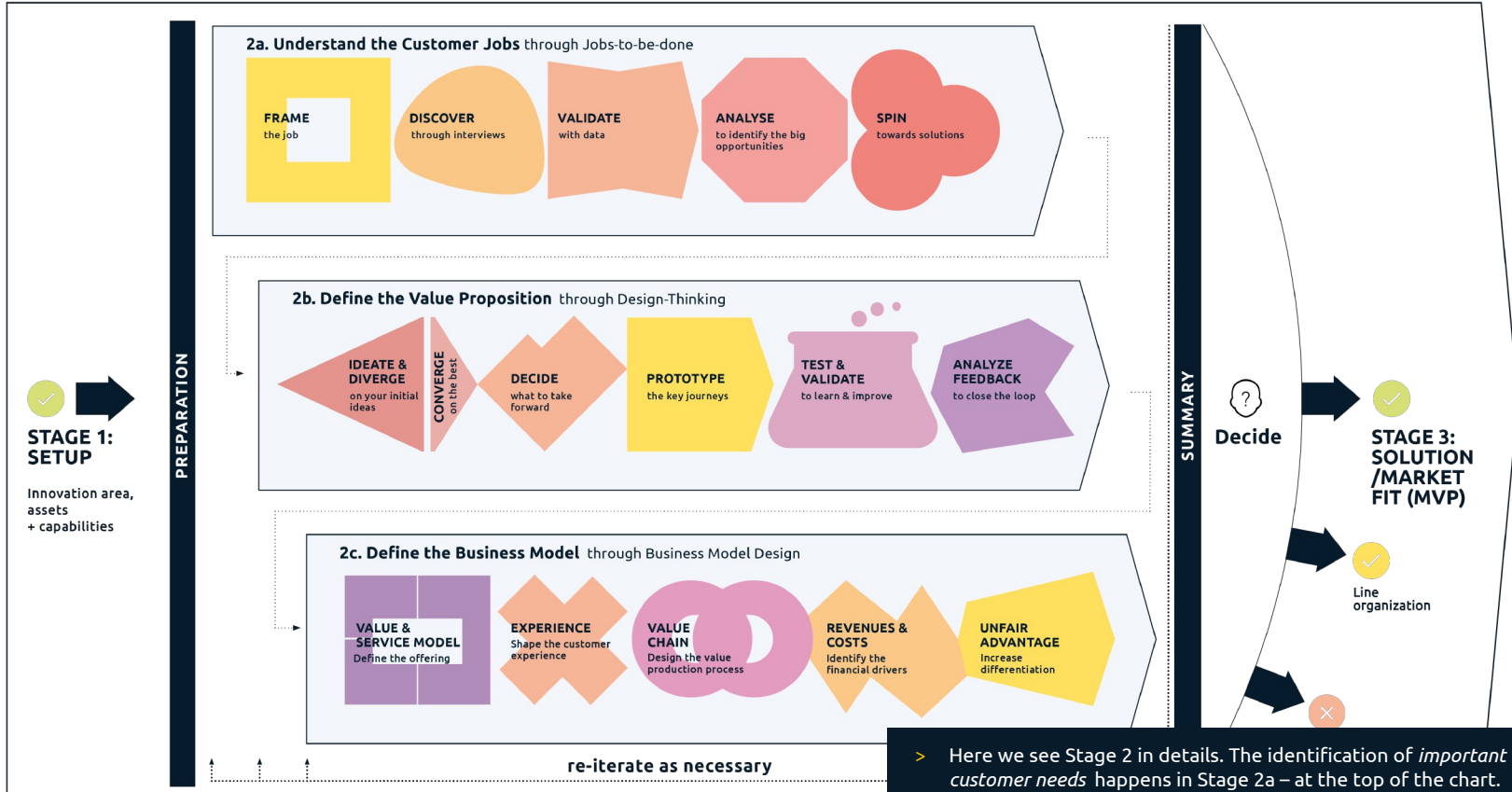
Definition of the business direction, search field & opportunity space, identification of capabilities to leverage, scouting for the team, and organizational setup.

Based on the opportunity space, thorough identification of the customers' needs (their Jobs-to-be-Done) and design of business concepts that respond to those needs, thereby achieving *qualitative Problem/Solution Fit*.

The Minimum Viable Product leads to a large-scale real-life validation and numerous iterations to achieve *quantitative Solution/Market Fit*. Once you prove that customers love the product/service and are willing to pay for it, the innovation is *investment-ready*.

Building and scaling the proven business model by now creating a permanent setup, putting in place an operating model and scaling it with marketing, technology and growth-hacking techniques.

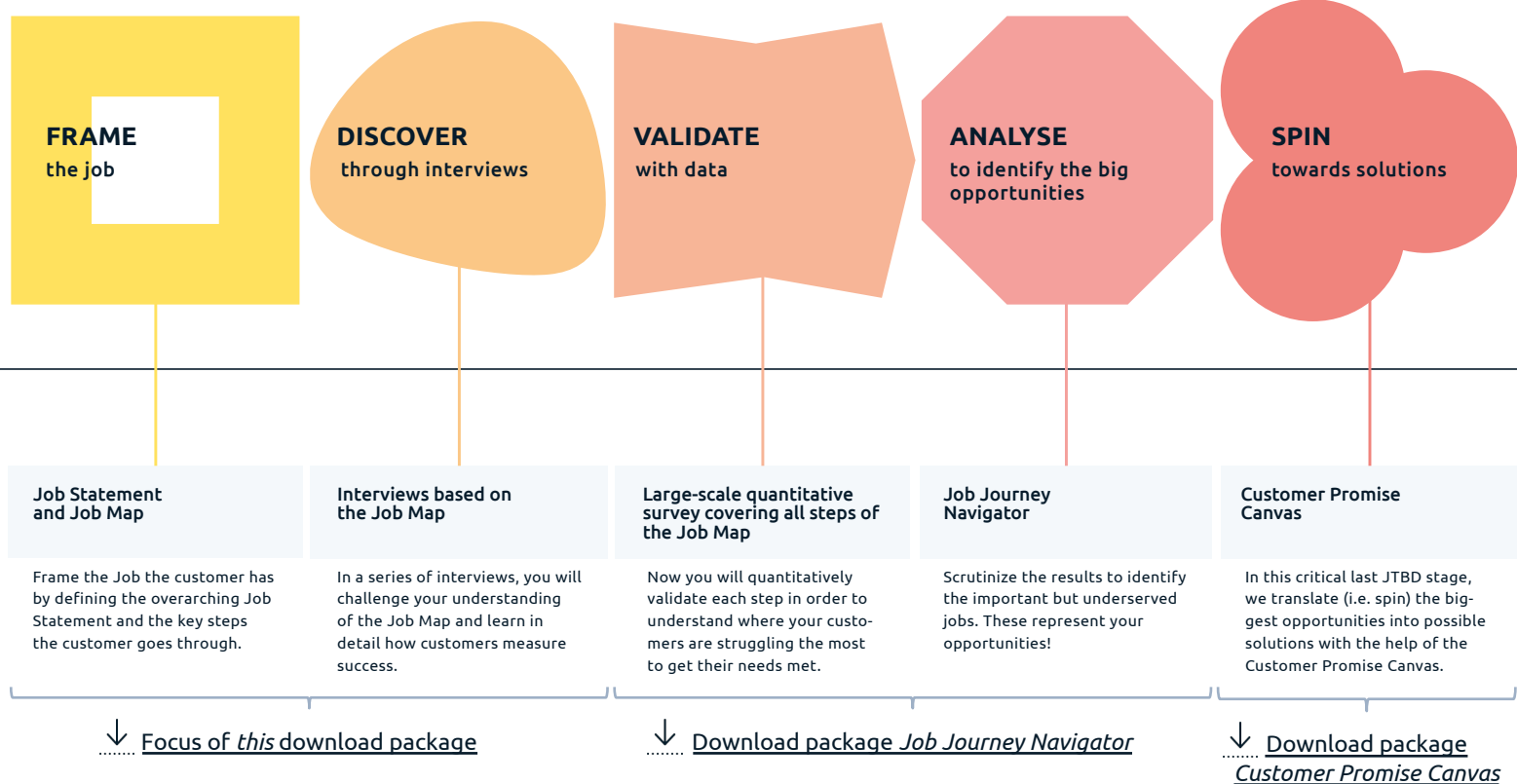
THE UNITE INNOVATION APPROACH - STAGE 2 | PROBLEM / SOLUTION FIT



- > Here we see Stage 2 in details. The identification of *important but unmet customer needs* happens in Stage 2a – at the top of the chart.
- > You will get to know the detailed JTBD process on the next page...
- > Download the full UNITE Innovation Framework here: <https://digitalleadership.com/UNITE/innovation-methodology>

THE UNITE OVERVIEW OF THE JOBS TO BE DONE PROCESS - helping you understand at what stage and in what context you will work on Jobs to be Done

2a. Understand the Customer Jobs through Jobs-to-be-done



Background to the UNITE Jobs to be Done Statement & Map

Why we use it

Companies often build new products that no one wants! As a result, most organizations lack the understanding of what their customers truly need and thus miss critical opportunities.

The customer's unmet need should be at the heart of your innovation process. That is why we use Jobs to be Done to identify it. These two tools will help you articulate the customer's basic job and then discover the smaller tasks that customers will need to do to meet it.

How it works

You are going to frame a Job to be Done, in two steps:

1. The one sentence Job Statement helps you articulate the customer's need in a given situation using their voice.
2. The eight steps of the Job Map help you discover the smaller tasks and activities customers are doing to accomplish their job. Put these eight boxes up on a big whiteboard, and work with your team to fill in the tasks and activities that you think your customer might be engaging in during each of these steps.

In later steps, you will validate the Job Map through customer interviews and a large quantitative survey.

What is the goal

A successful and customer-centric innovation process. Solving a problem for a customer is not only the best way to ensure that you aren't wasting resources building something that no one wants; it's the key to designing a truly innovative product and operating in a blue ocean.

> **Please read** the related chapter "Understanding Context" and "UNITE Innovation Approach" in the book to fully understand the concept of Jobs to be Done. You will only fully benefit from those models after familiarizing yourself with the concept of Jobs to be Done.

THE UNITE JOBS TO BE DONE STATEMENT & MAP

A. Job Statement

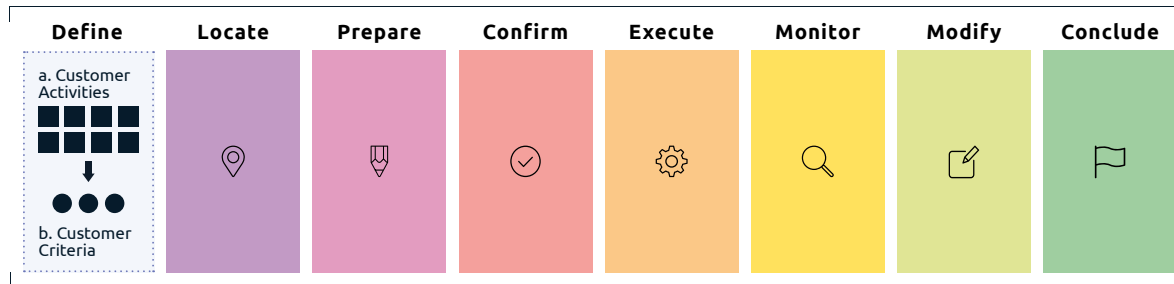
The Job Statement is one sentence describing the **whole** context where we are looking to help the customer. It is in the voice of the customer and describes the progress they are trying to achieve or struggle they are trying to overcome within a given situation.

"what is the progress I am trying to achieve or struggle I am trying to overcome"



B. The Job Map

The Job Map breaks the bigger Job down into eight logical steps to help us understand
 a. the customer's **activities** as they are trying to accomplish their job, and
 b. the **criteria** a customer uses to assess if a Job is done well or not

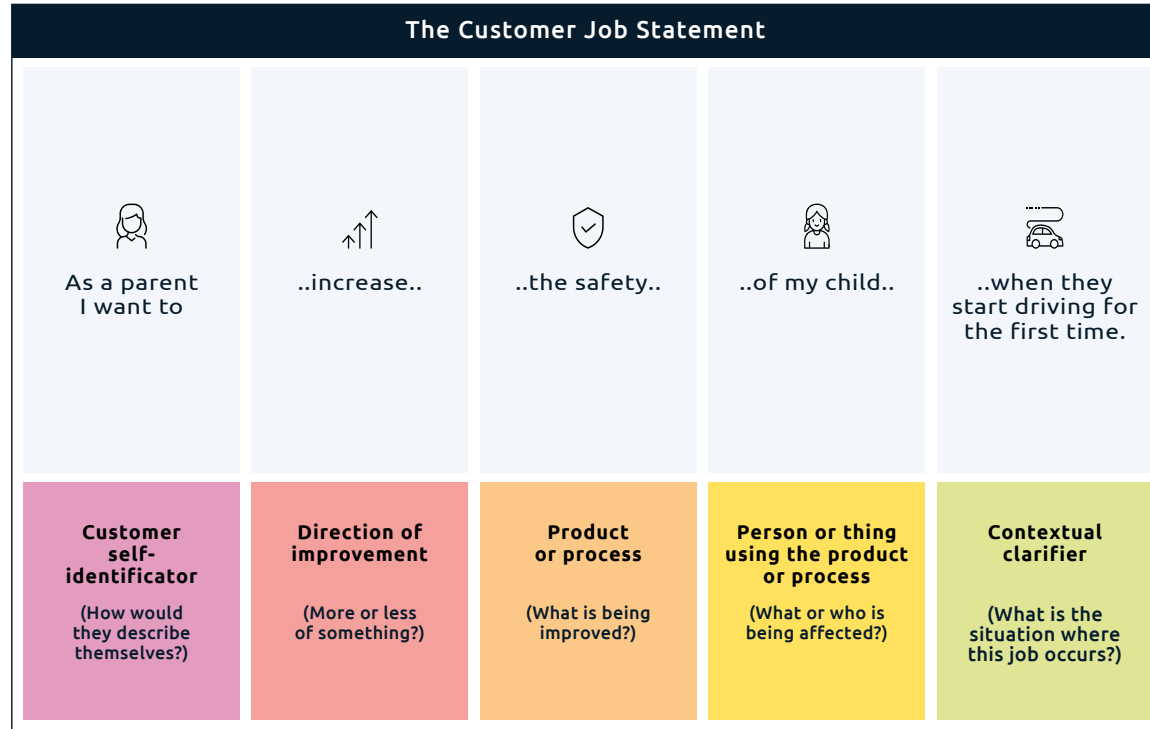


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Let's deep-dive on both ...

THE UNITE JOBS TO BE DONE CUSTOMER'S JOB STATEMENT



- > Use the Job Statement to frame your overall Job-to-be-Done.
- > The customer's Job Statement uses a simple sentence structure using the customer's own words, describing the outcome he is ultimately hoping to achieve or struggle he wants to overcome.

Additional suggestions to define the customer's Job Statement

We recommend the following sentence structure for clarity:

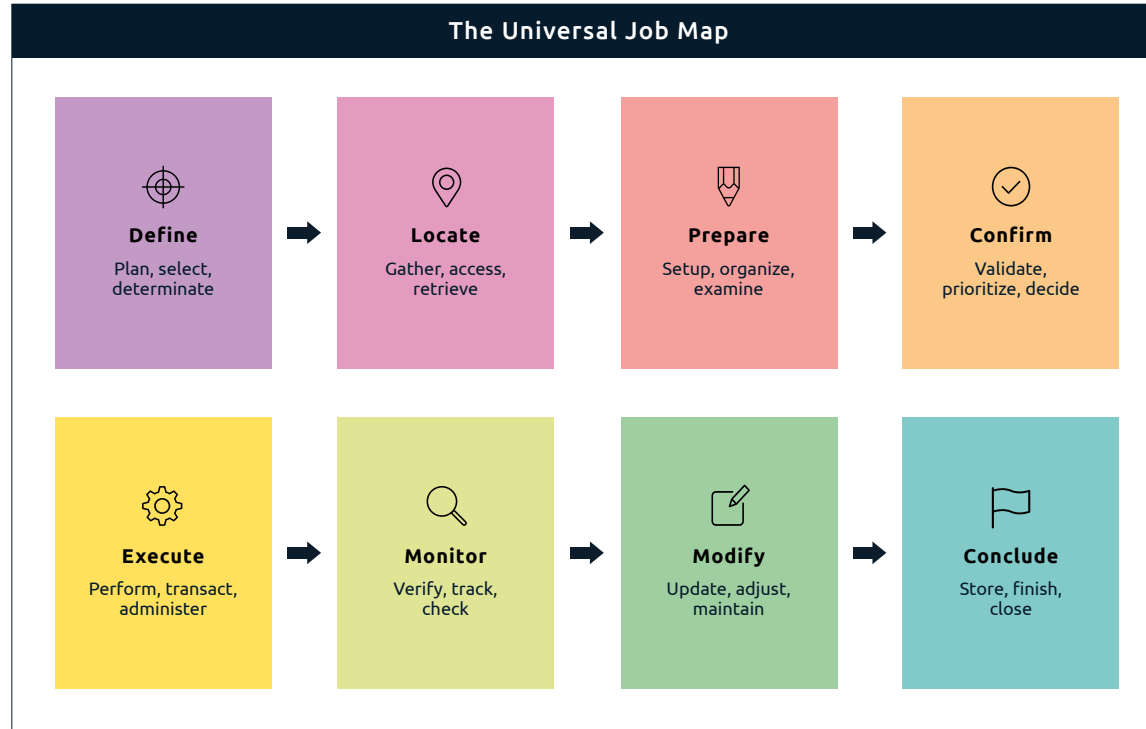
- > **The customer's voice:** The statement is to be written from the customer's perspective using their words and way of seeing the world. Start the statement with how they would identify themselves in this context. For example, "As a parent I want to ..."
- > **The direction of improvement:** What is the type of improvement the customer wants? For example, increase, decrease, etc.
- > **What is being improved:** For example, health, taste, efficiency or safety.
- > **What or who is being affected by the improvement?** For example, ordering produce, planning financial health, finding the right wine or securing the health and safety of your family,
- > **Contextual clarifier:** What describes the specific situation the customer is in?

This statement should be simple and unambiguous. It should, as clearly as possible, describe the customers context and what they are hoping to achieve. Most importantly, the job should be solution- agnostic, otherwise you lose the innovation power that makes JTBD unique.

A few examples of common errors when writing the Job Statement:

- > **Using your words, not the customers:** Teams can easily use their own specialist terms and perspectives. Ask yourself, would a customer use these words to describe their experience?
- > **Remember the customer is not you:** Sometimes we assume the customer already knows the problem we want to solve or the product we haven't made yet. Be sure the statement reflects the current knowledge and awareness of the customer.
- > **The full picture:** The customer always has a bigger perspective. Make sure not to describe your solution, but the customers situation where your future product has a role.

THE UNITE JOBS TO BE DONE UNIVERSAL JOB MAP



- > Using the eight steps of the Job Map you are going to outline the smaller tasks and activities customers are doing to accomplish their job.
- > Gather your team in an online environment or a physical room, find a big white board or wall, add eight columns, one for each of the steps, and start adding all the tasks and activities you can think of that the customer might go through to complete their job.

Additional suggestions to define the Job Map

The eight steps in the Job Map are:

1. **Define and plan:** The customer consciously or subconsciously creates an initial plan for their approach to achieving their goal.
2. **Locate the input needed:** The customer identifies and locates the information necessary for them to decide what to do.
3. **Prepare:** The customer organizes and makes sense of the information, filters and qualifies it, establishes theories and goes to find more information or chooses to make a decision about what to do.
4. **Confirm and validate:** The customer makes a decision to take action and validates it.
5. **Execute:** The customer performs the action or procedure leading from the decision.
6. **Monitor:** As the decision is executed the customer monitors the effects and outcome.
7. **Modify:** Monitoring creates new information which leads the customer to assess their original
8. decision. Did they make a good decision, or do they need to go back and make a new decision based on their new data? Do they just conclude (move to the next phase), or do they continuously monitor and improve their decision?
9. **Conclude:** In some jobs the customer concludes at some point that their journey is over. They take stock of their situation based on their assessment from the modify phase and conclude if they were happy or not and learn from it.

For example, the steps you take to purchase a bottle of wine are very different from those you use to buy a car. Understanding each step in the process is critical for your team to create a solution that precisely fulfils the important but underserved JTBD. The Job Map gives the team an opportunity to investigate what the customer is doing more thoroughly.

Note!

- > These steps aren't necessarily sequential or linear. That is why it is called a map and not a journey. There might be loops, sending the customer back and forth between the steps. Some of the steps might happen in parallel. Some steps might be intuitive and take seconds to complete, while for others the same step might take weeks or months.
- > The amount of tasks and activities you will be able to identify depends on the job, but don't be surprised if you identify 100 or more activities connected with your job.
- > Different customers will try to solve the job differently. You are not trying to find one optimal way of solving the job at this stage in your process; you want to map out every possible way your customers are currently trying to solve it.

JTBD – Step 2: Discovering through interviews

Jobs are not made up; they are discovered. Qualitative interviews are a cornerstone of Jobs to be Done, and these interviews should be done by your own team. They should be firsthand. Your team should aim to individually interview and/or observe 16–24 representative customers.

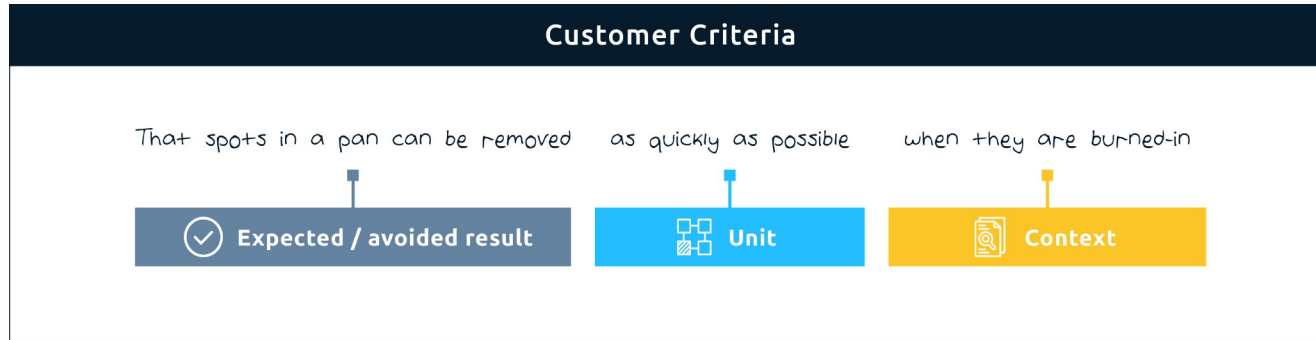
Initial interviews: Validating the main steps of the job

- > In the first few interviews, you will refine your Job Statement and improve the initial Job Map. Simply take both to the interview and examine it with the customer. The Job Map is best laid out on a wall with Post-it notes so you can easily interrogate it step-by-step with the customer. After a few interviews (on average six, in our experience) and shuffling around the individual steps, your Job Map should stabilize.
- > In subsequent interviews you will discover more options, leading to different segments and Personas, and, as you progress, you will dive deeper and deeper into customers' details, priorities and subconscious motivations.

Later interviews: Understanding the Customer Criteria

- > The focus of the subsequent interviews shifts to understanding the mindset and motivations of your customers and collecting the criteria a customer uses to assess if a job is well done or not.
- > **There are three main types of criteria to look out for:**
 - > **Functional criteria:** Needing more or less of something, e.g., faster, simpler, cheaper etc.
 - > **Emotional criteria:** Fulfilling needs like reduced stress, increased safety, comfort, personal mastery or accomplishment
 - > **Social criteria:** Like increased trust, openness, willingness to participate or connection
- > Customers will have their own criteria for each step in the Job Map. So, as you go through each step with a customer in an interview, collect the Customer Criteria, with the last interviews increasingly shifting to ensuring completeness and validating accuracy.
- > The functional, emotional and social criteria are collected as simple statements articulating what improvement the customer is hoping to achieve and how they would measure this. The following figure highlights the components of criteria, though it is recommended that you find the level of rigor and detail most relevant for you and your project.

THE UNITE JOBS TO BE DONE TEMPLATE FOR DEFINING CUSTOMER CRITERIA



- > Each of the eight steps in the Job Map will be evaluated by your customers through a number of different criteria. These can be **functional criteria** (such as in this example), **emotional** or **social** criteria.
- > Examples of functional criteria could include:
 - > Reduce the amount of downtime needed to change the component of an industry robot
 - > Reduce the time needed to find the unique part number of a product
 - > Improve the ability to integrate with previously purchased products
- > For each job step, you typically get anywhere from 5–15 Customer Criteria. After you have gone through all of your interviews, you typically end up with a long list of 200–300 Customer Criteria. Consolidate and filter these to get to the 50–150 most important Customer Criteria that your target group desires. Your final list of Customer Criteria will be a critical input for the next stage, validation.

Interview Guidelines

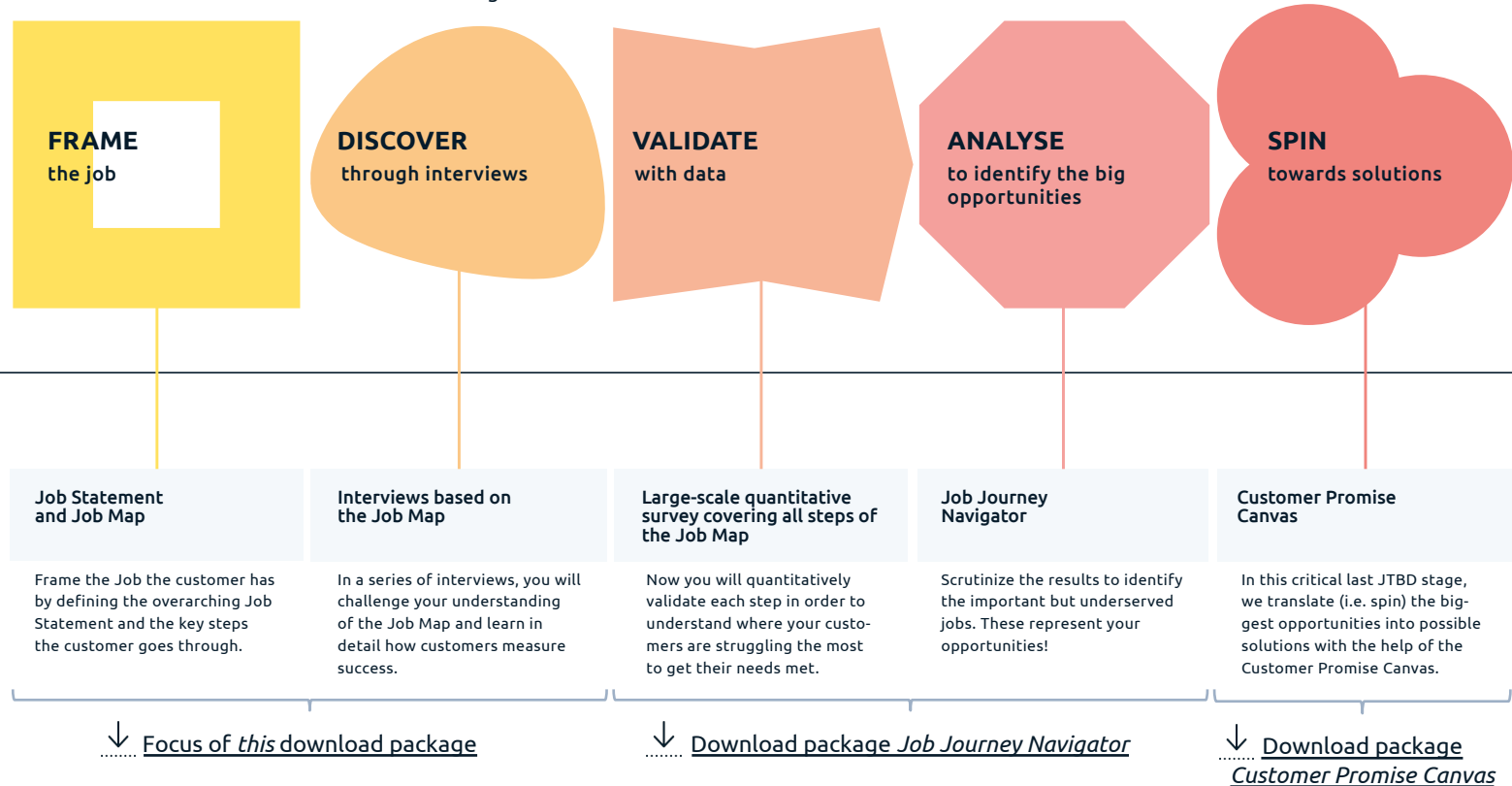
- > Having team members directly meet the customer is a critical source of learning and will infuse the project with passion, better understanding and ultimately better solution quality. Having team members run interviews is therefore the way to go. But not every person is trained to conduct interviews! We want therefore to share some of the key lessons we have learned in order to help you avoid some common mistakes. In the end, however, get support from experts if you lack interview experience.
- > Qualitative interviews are a *learning journey*. You need to make sure you use the data you uncover to continuously update your questions in order to reflect what you know. If you assume you already know the most important questions to ask customers, it exposes your work to a lot of bias and risk.
- > The purpose of a qualitative interview is also not to gather quantitative data, e.g., that 5 of the 16 people you interviewed had one type of preference. The purpose is to go on a journey of discovery exploring and learning about your customers.
- > Thus, use the interviews to explore and discover your customers. Towards the end you will recognize repeating patterns that strengthen your hypotheses, helping you specify your what you have learned and create clearer segments.
- > Critical to interviewing is to apply rigor and be aware of potential biases. Make sure the people you interview are representative of your real target group (and not just friends, family or random people you select on the street or who come by your website). The second is to be aware of all potential biases both from you and your customer when interviewing them.
- > **Preparing an interview guide:** An interview is a conversation with your customer, and your questions will help guide your way through the discussion. But don't follow it slavishly since you don't know what you will uncover. Any response from the customer might invite further probing questions that you need to come up with on the fly. Use the guide mostly to remind you of potential biases, and make sure you get through your important topics before the interview ends.

Common risks to look out for:

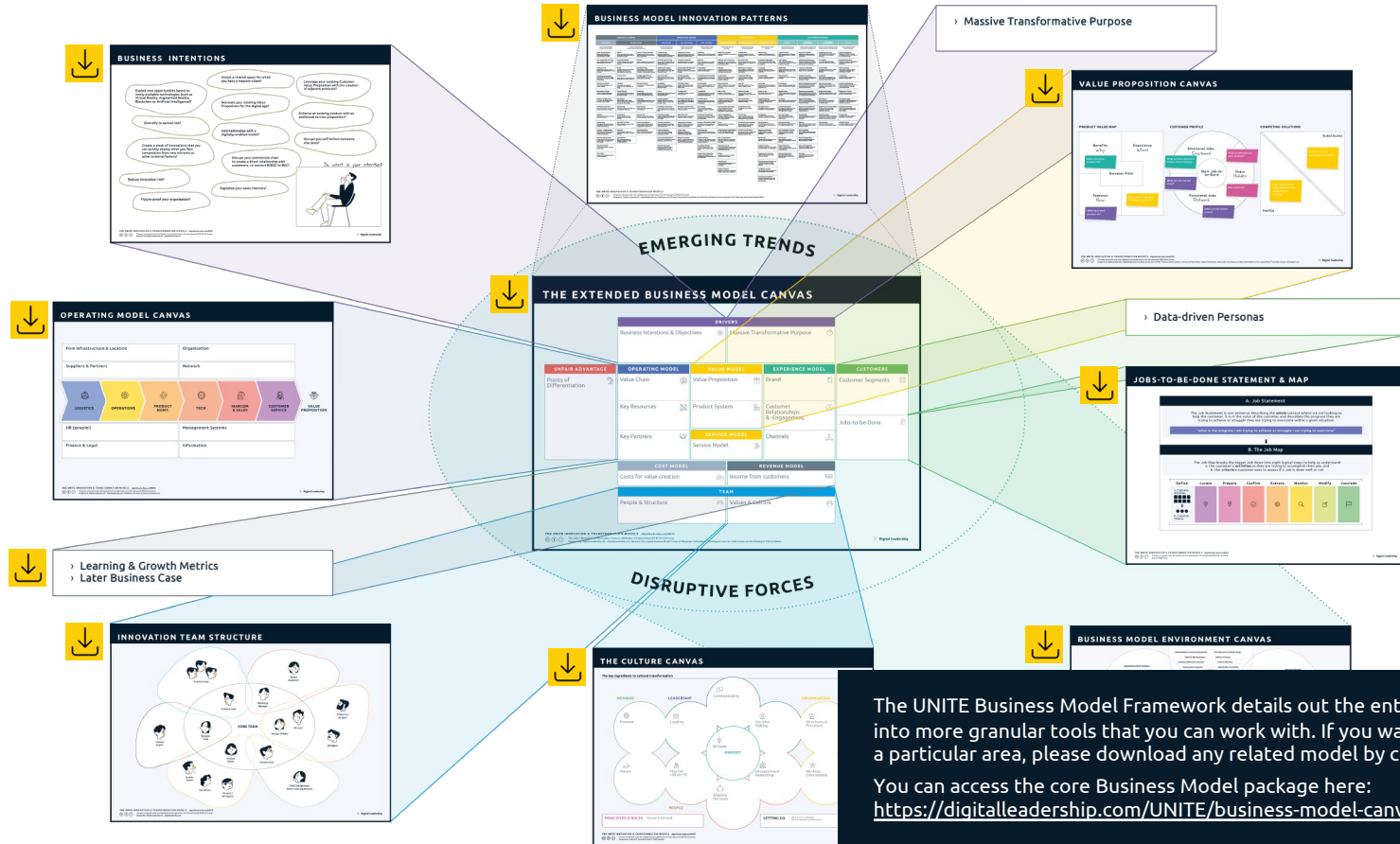
- > **Confirmation bias:** Your team is likely to amplify evidence that confirms what you already think is true and disregards evidence to the contrary. Be conscious of the reflections and decisions you make and which findings you consider more or less significant.
- > **Leading questions:** Any question you ask the customer could easily either suggest what you are hoping to learn or lead the customer towards what answer she thinks you want to hear. Be careful.
- > **Interpretation bias:** Every analyst has a bias. Make sure more people participate in each interview or analyze the recording afterwards. The more analysts the less risk.
- > **Interjecting your own opinions:** Interviewers shouldn't add their own opinions or perspectives to the interview. The customer is trying to be helpful and might adapt to your perspective instead of sharing their own.
- > **Political correctness:** Very few people would admit to doing something bigoted, immoral or foolish. Be wary when interviewing that there are some truths people would never confess to.

THE UNITE OVERVIEW OF THE JOBS TO BE DONE PROCESS - helping you understand at what stage and in what context you will work on Jobs to be Done

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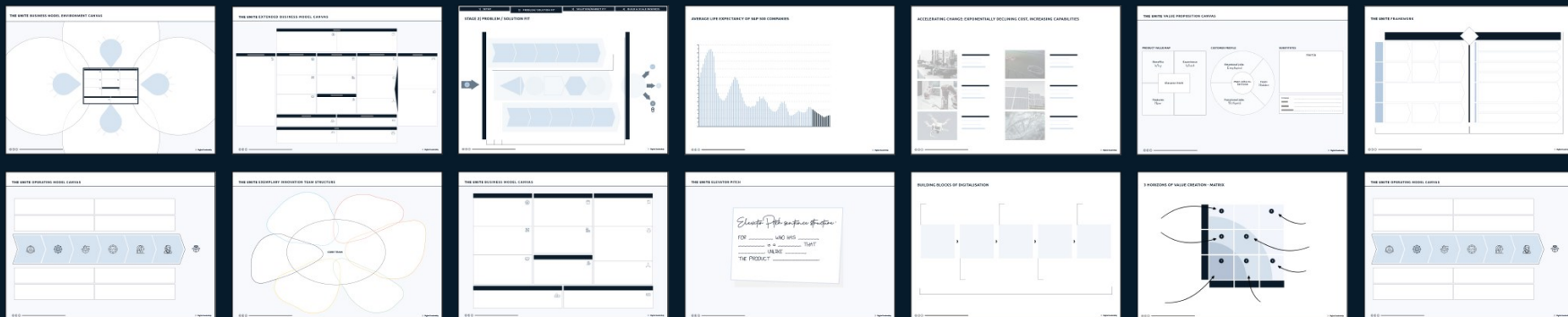


OVERVIEW OF THE ENTIRE UNITE BUSINESS MODEL FRAMEWORK – which helps you understand the role of the Business Model Canvas in context



The UNITE Business Model Framework details out the entire Business Model into more granular tools that you can work with. If you want to deep-dive on a particular area, please download any related model by clicking on it.

You can access the core Business Model package here:
<https://digitalleadership.com/UNITE/business-model-canvas>



How to CREATE INNOVATION (including a detailed description of all tools and canvases) is available here:

<http://digitalleadership.com/createinnovation>

The full library of UNITE Innovation & Transformation tools and canvases are available here: <http://digitalleadership.com/UNITE>.

All models are OpenSource and are available free of charge!





How to Create Innovation is a practical, comprehensive, OpenSource guide for successful corporate innovation. The UNITE initiative and movement, spearheaded by Stefan F. Dieffenbacher and Caroline Hüttinger and a diverse team of industry leaders and innovation researchers, aims to spark a revolution in global innovation and transformation.

How to Create Innovation is a workbook for students, innovators, designers, government and corporate leaders who appreciate and are curious around the pace of innovation and emerging technologies. It challenges the status quo of our mindsets, beliefs and strategic approaches required for the next part of the journey. Leverage the UNITE Innovation & Transformation framework to build your own story and create a world worth living in!

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**»We build digital winners.
It's what we are made for. Let's create winning
digital businesses – together. And, at the same
time, let's create a world worth living in.«**

Digital Leadership is a strategy-execution firm built on strong and innovative values. We support our customers in strategizing, building and securing their future through the creation of fully digitally enabled, and extraordinarily successful, products and businesses. Our agile, lean, fast-track business setup, coupled with access to an extensive pool of highly specialized and trusted resources, allows for ideating and building in an effective and meaningful way.

Shared goals are the cornerstone of our customer approach. To date, our team has successfully led 74 projects with numerous global players across all industry sectors, ranging from \$50,000 projects to \$100 million programs. But helping our customers' build their futures is not enough. We are committed to changing the world through the sharing of powerful innovation and transformation practices. Join the UNITE movement and help us start an innovation revolution.



For all types of inquiries
– project requests, experts, training
& coaching, feedback, or questions
– be invited to contact us!

You want to actively support the
UNITE movement? We are looking for
partners, authors and experts!

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